First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office: Tuesday - Friday: 9am- 2pm
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours:
Friday 9:30am-2:30pm and by Appointment
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent, pastoral matters outside of regular office hours, call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.
Scripture Reader: Chris Guzman
Acolytes: Sophia Gagnon, Kaia Newton, Mykala Pryor, and Ada Sanders

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:
June 8, 2025
10 A.M.

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Bailey Brown, Music and Choral Director
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Stephen McLaughlin, Office Manager
27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555

info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

We Gather as God's People

Centering Words:

Where there is love, there is life.

— Mahatma Gandhi

❖ BEGINNING OF SERVICE ❖

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

Prelude *Morning Has Broken* Gaelic Melody

Welcome and Announcement

Sung Call To Worship *Bless the Lord, My Soul* (Taizé)

Bless the Lord, my soul
and Bless God's Holy name
Bless the Lord, my soul
who leads me into life.

Morning Prayer[1] **(Unison)**

First Congregational Church of St. Albans, Vermont, a congregation of the United Church of Christ, is created to provide a place for all people to worship God, serve God and humanity, and grow in faith and fellowship. All persons are created in God's image and are loved, valued, and blessed equally by God.

This community of faith is an Open and Affirming congregation, which welcomes all persons, including those of all races, ethnicities, ages, sexual orientations, gender identities and expressions, family structures, faith backgrounds, abilities, and economic circumstances. All persons are invited to fully share and participate in leadership, ministry, fellowship, worship, sacraments, responsibilities, blessings, and joys of our church family.

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!

If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).

If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*Please Stand If You Are Able

[1]FCC Open and Affirming Covenant

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Mission Highlight

The Welcome Home Initiative:
First Congregational Church of St. Albans is a founding member of the Welcome Home Initiative (WH). WH provides people transitioning from homelessness to permanent housing in Franklin and Grand Isle Counties of Vermont with new- home essentials (mop, broom, dishes, cleaners, trash can, pots & pans, etc.), personal items (shampoo, deodorant, etc.), and nonperishable food items.

The Welcome Home Initiative is a collaboration among:

- Franklin/Grand Isle CVOEO- Community Action
- First Congregational Church of St Albans
- Grace Episcopal Church, Sheldon
- St. Luke's Episcopal Church, St. Albans
- Sheldon Interfaith Food Shelf
- Holy Trinity Episcopal Church, Swanton
- Congregational Church of So. Hero
- St. Martins of Tours Inclusive Catholic Community
- Our local Girl Scout Troop

WH works with local housing case workers from:

- F/GI Community Action
- Voices Against Violence
- Samaritan House
- Restorative Justice Center
- Pathways
- Reach-Up
- Spectrum Youth and Family Services

First Congregational Church functions as the fiscal agent, collection center and pick-up hub for the program. WH serves on average 6-7 individuals/families to be housed a month.

Hymn*

Love Divine, All Loves Excelling (1,2,4) NCH 43

Prayer of Confession & Transformation

One: Humans of God's creation, we are diverse.
Many: We are beautiful. We are unique. We judge each other's differences, yet our diversity is an illustration of the infinite mystery of God.
All: The God in me sees the God in you.
One: Humans of God's creation, we are political.
Many: We are conservative. We are liberal. We are passionate about our views, yet we are complacent in systems of injustice.
All: The God in me hears the God in you.
One: Humans of God's creation, we have bodies.
Many: We are queer. We are gay. We are straight. We are transgender. We shame each other's bodies, yet we are all made in the image of God.
All: The God in me loves the God in you.
One: Humans of God's creation, we are theological.
Many: We are human. We are divine. We often feel alone, yet we are bound by the energy of God.
All: The God in me is the God in you.

Pause for Reflection

Words of Assurance

Passing of the Peace

THE MESSAGE

Graduate Blessing

Anthem *Love is Love* Abbie Betinis

Scripture Reading Acts 2:1-21

Contemporary Reading:

And They All Understood Ana Gobledale

Morning Reflection *Is It Just Me, or Is It Windy?*

Hymn* ***Spirit, Spirit of Gentleness*** (1,3,4) NHC 286

THE THANKSGIVING

Sharing Our Joys and Concerns

Choral Call to Prayer:

Hear Our Prayer, O Lord D. Welpton

Prayer of the People ~

Lord's Prayer

Our Father who art in heaven hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power and the glory, forever, Amen

Choral Response to Prayer

"*Thou wilt keep him in perfect peace, whose mind is stayed on Thee.*" Scottish Psalter, 1615

OFFERTORY

Doxology

Praise God from whom all blessing flow
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

Offertory Prayer

THE DEPARTURE

Hymn* ***In Christ There is No East or West*** NCH 394

Benediction

Postlude *Yesterday* P. McCartney
arr. S.Conrady

❖ END OF SERVICE ❖

Announcements:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

- Alan Shannon Thank You for planting flowers, tomatoes, and blueberries. What a lovely way to greet people as they enter from the parking lot!
- Valerie Odrechowski Thank You for planting the beautiful flowers in the backyard of the church. It makes it the perfect spot for quiet reflection!
- Sandy Cristman Thank You for decorating the church - so beautiful and festive!

Tuesday, June 10, at 6 P.M. in the Sanctuary
Concert of Sacred Music - Free
In partnership with the Seventh-Day Adventist Church, and featuring internationally-known opera singer Wylie Tatum.

Saturday, June 14
All-Church Picnic
@ The Browns' Camp in Swanton
Noon-4pm
Please sign-up during Coffee Hour.

Saturday, June 21; 7-9pm
Open-Mic
All Ages & Free
Come play, sing, or just listen and relax!
Pot-luck dinner.

Bible Study: Last Session before summer break!
Wednesday, July 11 @ 7pm
John 16:12-15



Wifi:
Sanctuary
sanctuary123